

Median Age of the Population

The median age is the specific age that divides a population into two numerically equal groups. Simply, a half of the population (50%) is older than the median age, while the other half is younger. A low median age indicates a population structure with a large child population and high birth rates, leading to an increased demand for education, pediatric healthcare, and youth-oriented services. Conversely, a high median age reflects a trend of population aging and a growing elderly population.

According to Table 6.1.7, the median age of population of Sri Lanka remained at a relatively low level between 1946 and 1971, reaching a notable low of 19.4 years in 1963. By 1981, the median age increased to 21.4 years, showing no significant difference between males and females. However, notable increases were observed thereafter: the median age increased by approximately 9 years between 1981 and 2012, and by approximately 5 years between 2012 and 2024.

Table 6.1.7 : Median Age of the Population, 1946-2024

Census Year	Total (Years)	Male (Years)	Female (Years)
1946	21.3	22.1	20.5
1953	20.8	21.7	19.9
1963	19.4	20.0	18.4
1971	19.7	20.0	19.3
1981	21.4	21.5	21.4
2012	30.0	30.0	31.0
2024	35.0	34.0	36.0